

Wakantanka (Many and Great)

Text: Dakota; Joseph R. Renville, 1846; paraphr. Philip Frazier, 1929, alt.

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is presented in three systems, each with a treble clef and a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The time signature is 2/4. Above each system, guitar chords are indicated: C#m, F#m, and C#m. Fingerings are provided for the left hand: 1 2 4 for C#m and 2 1 3 for F#m. The lyrics are written in English and Dakota, with some lines in italics. The first system includes two verses of English lyrics and one line of Dakota. The second system includes two verses of English lyrics and one line of Dakota. The third system includes two verses of English lyrics and one line of Dakota.

System 1:

1 Wa - kan-tan - ka ta - ku ni - ta - wa tan - ka-ya qa o - ta;
2 Wo - eh - da - ku ni - ta - wa kin he mi - na-gi kin qu wo;
1 *Man - y and great, O God, are your works, mak - er of earth and sky.*
2 *Grant un - to us com-mun-ion with you, O star-a - bid - ing One.*

System 2:

ma - hpi - ya kin e - ya - hna-ke ça, ma-ka kin he du - o - wan - ca;
ma - hpi - ya kin i - wan-kam ya - ti, wi - co - wa - šte yu - ha nan - ka,
Your hands have set the heav-ens with stars; your fin-gers spread the moun-tains and plains
Come un - to us and dwell with us; with you are found the gifts of life.

System 3:

mni - o-wan - ca šbe - ya wan-ke cin, he - na o - ya - ki - hi.
wi - co-ni kin he ma - ya - qu nun, o - wi-han - ke wa - nin.
Lo, at your word the wa - ters were formed; deep seas o - bey your voice.
Bless us with life that has no end, e - ter-nal life with you.